

PREMIUM GUIDE

UNIVERSITY OF MALAYA

Complete Admission Guide for Indian Students

Programs, Fees, Scholarships, Placements & Campus Life

Kuala Lumpur, Kuala Lumpur

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1. University of Malaya at a Glance

#60

QS RANKING

1905

FOUNDED

30,000

STUDENTS

3,000+

INDIAN STUDENTS

82%

PLACEMENT RATE

Attribute	Details
Full Name	University of Malaya
Location	Kuala Lumpur, Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia
Type	Public (Est. 1905)
Acceptance Rate	40%
Student-Faculty Ratio	11:1
Graduation Rate	78%
International Students	20%
Gender Ratio	55:45 (F:M)
Website	um.edu.my
Motto	Malaysia's #1 University — Affordable Excellence in Asia

The University of Malaya is Malaysia's oldest and highest-ranked university. Located in Kuala Lumpur, UM offers world-class education at a fraction of Western costs. With 3,000+ Indian students, a large Tamil-speaking community, and tropical weather, it feels like home away from home.

Notable Alumni

Tun Mahathir Mohamad — Former Prime Minister of Malaysia

2. Why Choose University?

- Malaysia's #1 university (QS #60)
- Tuition is 70% cheaper than USA/UK — best value in Asia
- 3,000+ Indian students — massive Tamil community
- English-taught programs — no language barrier
- KL is a modern, multicultural city with amazing food
- Easy 6-month job search visa after graduation

Academic Environment

Solid and affordable. UM doesn't have the research prestige of NUS or ANU, but the education is good and incredibly affordable. English-taught programs are well-structured. The 1-2 year format is flexible. Many Indian students use UM as a stepping stone.

Student Life

KL feels like home. Little India (Brickfields) is right next to campus. Tamil is spoken everywhere. The food is incredible — Indian, Malay, Chinese, all cheap and delicious. The nightlife in Bukit Bintang is vibrant. Weekend trips to Langkawi, Genting, and Singapore.

3. Programs & Courses

Popular Programs for Indian Students

Program	Level	Duration	Tuition		Highlights
Master of Computer Science	PG	1-2 Years	MYR	15K-20K/yr	Software engineering, AI, and data science.
Master of Business Administration	PG	1-2 Years	MYR	20K-25K/yr	General MBA with Asian business focus.
Master of Data Science	PG	1-2 Years	MYR	18K-22K/yr	ML, big data analytics, and business intelligence.

4. Eligibility & Requirements

Admission Requirements

Requirement	Details
GPA	6.0+ (First Class)
GRE	Not required
IELTS	6.0+
TOEFL	80+
Work Experience	2+ years (MBA)
LORs	2 LORs
SOP	Required
Resume	Required
Interview	MBA only
Application Fee	MYR 300

5. Application Deadlines

Intake	Deadline	Decision Date
Semester 1 (Mar)	Jan 15	Feb 15
Semester 2 (Oct)	Aug 15	Sep 15

6. Tuition & Cost of Living

Expense Category	Cost
Tuition (MS)	MYR 15,000-25,000/yr
Accommodation	MYR 7,000-14,000/yr
Food	MYR 3,000-5,000/yr
Transport	MYR 1,200/yr
Health Insurance	MYR 500/yr
Personal	MYR 2,000-4,000/yr

7. Scholarships & Funding

Scholarship	Amount	Eligibility	Deadline
Malaysia International Scholarship (MIS)	Full tuition + living allowance	International students with strong academics	Mar 15
UM Graduate Scholarship	MYR 3,000-8,000/yr	Merit-based	Rolling

8. Placements & Career Outcomes

82% PLACEMENT RATE	MYR 60,000 AVG SALARY	MYR 120,000 HIGHEST SALARY	400+ COMPANIES
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Post-Study Work Pathway

6-month job search visa → Employment Pass → PR (after 5 years) | Work visa duration: 6 months (job search) → Employment Pass

9. Campus Life for Indians

Aspect	Details
Indian Association	University of Malaya Indian Society — 800+ members
Accommodation	On-campus hostels + off-campus apartments in KL
Avg Rent	MYR 600-1,200/month
Indian Food	Brickfields (Little India) — walking distance. Banana leaf, roti canai, thosai everywhere.
Weather	Tropical — hot and humid year-round (25-33°C). Monsoon rains.
Transport	LRT + Monorail + Grab (cheap!)
Healthcare	Private clinics on campus + public hospitals
Safety	Safe. KL is generally secure for students.

Nightlife & Social Scene

Bukit Bintang for clubs and bars. Changkat for rooftop bars. Most students hang out in Bangsar or Mont Kiara.

Student Clubs & Societies

- **UM Indian Society** — Cultural
- **UM Tamil Society** — Cultural
- **Computer Science Society** — Tech
- **Data Science Club** — Tech
- **Bharatanatyam Club** — Dance
- **Cricket Club** — Sports
- **Entrepreneurship Club** — Entrepreneurship
- **Hiking Club** — Outdoor

11. What Students Say

"It feels like I'm in Chennai, not KL. Tamil everywhere, dosa for breakfast, and Diwali is a public holiday!"

— **Arjun, MSc CS '24**

"My total cost for 2 years is less than one semester in the US. And I'm getting a QS #60 degree."

— **Priya, MBA '25**

"KL is the food capital of Asia. Indian, Malay, Chinese, Japanese — every cuisine under \$5."

— **Rohan, MSc DS '24**

Your University Journey Starts Here

Get expert guidance on your University of Malaya application — SOP review, LOR templates, visa prep, and more.

www.kohortconnect.com

